7 Appropriate certificates of competency issued under the provisions of the 1978 STCW Convention for the holder to serve as a chief engineer officer, an engineer officer or GMDSS radio operator shall be deemed to be a corresponding certificate for the purposes of paragraph 1 with regard to fishing vessels.
8 Medical certificates issued in accordance with the provisions of regulation I/9 of
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SOURCE: MSC.561(108).pdf
URL: https://wwwcdn.imo.org/localresources/en/KnowledgeCentre/IndexofIMOResolutions/MSCResolutions/MSC.561(108).pdf
paragraph 1 with regard to fishing vessels.
8 Medical certificates issued in accordance with the provisions of regulation I/9 of
the 1978 STCW Convention shall be accepted as valid for the personnel of fishing vessels.
9 Subject to the variations permitted under formats 1, 2 and 3 of section A-I/3 of the STCW-F Code, Administrations may use a format different from the format given in the section provided that such format contains, as a minimum, the required information and that the particulars are inserted in Roman characters and Arabic figures.
RESOLUTION MSC.561(108) (adopted on 23 May 2024)
AMENDMENTS TO THE ANNEX TO THE INTERNATIONAL CONVENTION ON STANDARDS OF TRAINING, CERTIFICATION AND WATCHKEEPING FOR FISHING VESSEL PERSONNEL, 1995 (Revised annex to the 1995 STCW-F Convention)
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Regulation I/4
Control procedures
1 Control exercised by a duly authorized officer under article 8 shall be limited to the following:

SOURCE: MSC.561(108).pdf
URL: https://wwwcdn.imo.org/localresources/en/KnowledgeCentre/IndexofIMOResolutions/MSCResolutions/MSC.561(108).pdf
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Regulation I/4
Control procedures
1 Control exercised by a duly authorized officer under article 8 shall be limited to the following:
.1 verification that all fishing vessel personnel serving on board who are required to be certificated by this Convention are so certificated or hold the required dispensation. Such certificates shall be accepted unless there are clear grounds for believing that a certificate has been fraudulently obtained or that the holder of a certificate is not the person to whom that certificate was originally issued; and
.2 assessment of the ability of the fishing vessel personnel to maintain watchkeeping standards as required by the Convention if there are clear grounds for believing that such standards are not being maintained, because the following have occurred:
.1 the vessel has been involved in a collision, grounding or stranding; or
.2 there has been a discharge of substances from the vessel when
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SOURCE: MSC.561(108).pdf
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.1 the vessel has been involved in a collision, grounding or stranding;
or
.2 there has been a discharge of substances from the vessel when
under way, at anchor or at berth which is illegal under international
conventions; or
.3 the vessel has been manoeuvred in an erratic or unsafe manner,
whereby routeing measures adopted by the Organization, or safe
navigation practices and procedures, have not been followed; or
.4 the vessel is otherwise being operated in such a manner as to pose
a danger to persons, property or the environment.
2 In the event that deficiencies are found under paragraph 1, the officer carrying out the
control shall forthwith inform, in writing, the skipper of the vessel and the Administration, so
that appropriate action may be taken. Such notification shall specif y the details of the
deficiencies found and the grounds on which the Party determines that these deficiencies pose
a danger to persons, property or the environment.

SOURCE: MSC.561(108).pdf
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deficiencies found and the grounds on which the Party determines that these deficiencies pose
a danger to persons, property or the environment.
3 Deficiencies which may be deemed to pose a danger to persons, property or the
environment include the following:
.1 failure of persons, required to hold a certificate, to have an appropriate
certificate or dispensation;
.2 failure of navigational or engineering watch arrangements to conform to the
requirements specified for the vessel by the Administration;
.3 absence in a watch of a person qualified to operate equipment essential to
safe navigation, safety radio communications or the prevention of pollution;
or
.4 inability to provide rested persons for the first watch at the commencement
of a voyage, and for subsequent relieving watches.
RESOLUTION MSC.561(108) (adopted on 23 May 2024)
AMENDMENTS TO THE ANNEX TO THE INTERNATIONAL CONVENTION ON STANDARDS OF TRAINING, CERTIFICATION AND

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AMENDMENTS TO THE ANNEX TO THE INTERNATIONAL CONVENTION ON STANDARDS OF TRAINING, CERTIFICATION AND
WATCHKEEPING FOR FISHING VESSEL PERSONNEL, 1995 (Revised annex to the 1995 STCW-F Convention)

Regulation I/5
Communication of information
1 The Secretary -General shall, on request, provide Parties with any information
communicated under article 4.
2 A Party which fails to communicate information required by article 4 within 24 months
after the date of entry into force of the Convention for a Party shall not be entitled to claim the
privileges of this Convention until such time as the information has been received by the
Secretary-General.
Regulation I/6

Administration of certification arrangements
1 Each Party undertakes to establish and maintain a means of ensuring that programmes incorporating such instruction and practical training as is necessary to achieve the competency standards are regularly monitored to ensure their effectiveness.

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the competency standards are regularly monitored to ensure their effectiveness.
2 Each Party undertakes, to the extent practicable, to maintain a register or registers of all certificates and endorsements specified in regulations I/3 and II/1 to II/6 which are issued, have expired, or have been revalidated, reported lost, suspended or cancelled, and of dispensations issued, and provide information on the status of such certificates, endorsements and dispensations when so requested by another Party.
Regulation I/7
Recognition of certificates
1 Each Administration shall ensure, in order to recognize, by endorsement in accordance with regulation I/3, a certificate issued by or under the authority of another Party, that the requirements for standards of competence, as well as the issue and endorsement of certificates by that Party, are fully complied with.
2 Certificates issued by or under the authority of a non-Party shall not be recognized.

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that Party, are fully complied with.
2 Certificates issued by or under the authority of a non-Party shall not be recognized.
3 Notwithstanding the requirement of paragraph 1 of this regulation and paragraph 5 of regulation I/3, an Administration may, if circumstances require, allow a person to serve for a period not exceeding three months on board a vessel entitled to fly its flag while holding an appropriate and valid certificate issued by another Party without it being endorsed as required by paragraph 5 of regulation I/3 provided that documented proof is made available that application for an endorsement has been submitted to the Administration.
Regulation I/8
Transitional provisions
1 A certificate of competency or of service in a capacity for which this Convention requires a certificate and which before entry into force of the Convention for a Party is issued in accordance
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SOURCE: MSC.561(108).pdf
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certificate and which before entry into force of the Convention for a Party is issued in accordance
with the laws of that Party or the Radio Regulations shall be recognized as valid for service after entry into force of the Convention for that Party.
2 After the entry into force of the Convention for a Party, it may continue to issue certificates of competency in accordance with its previous practices for a period not exceeding five years. Such certificates shall be recognized as valid for the purpose of the Convention. During this transitional period, such certificates shall be issued only to persons who had commenced their sea service before entry into force of the Convention for that Party within the specific vessel department to which those certificates relate. The Party shall ensure that all other candidates for certification shall be examined and certificated in accordance with the Convention.

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examined and certificated in accordance with the Convention.
RESOLUTION MSC.561(108) (adopted on 23 May 2024)

3 A Party may, within two years after entry into force of the Convention for that Party, issue a certificate of service to fishing vessel personnel who hold neither an appropriate certificate under the Convention nor a certificate of competency issued unde r its laws before entry into force of the Convention for that Party but who have:
.1 served in the capacity for which they seek a certificate of service for not less than three years at sea within the last seven years preceding entry into force of the Convention for that Party;
.2 produced evidence that they have performed that service satisfactorily; and
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of the Convention for that Party;
.2 produced evidence that they have performed that service satisfactorily; and
.3 satisfied the Party as to medical fitness, including eyesight and hearing, taking into account their age at the time of application.
For the purpose of the Convention, a certificate of service issued under this paragraph shall be regarded as the equivalent of a certificate issued under the Convention.
Regulation I/9
Dispensation
1 In circumstances of exceptional necessity, an Administration, if in its opinion this will not cause danger to persons, property or the environment, may issue a dispensation permitting a person to serve in a specified fishing vessel for a specified period not exceeding six months in a capacity, other than that of the radio operator, except as provided by the relevant Radio Regulations, for which the person does not hold the appropriate certificate, provided that the
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Regulations, for which the person does not hold the appropriate certificate, provided that the person to whom the dispensation is issued shall be adequately qualified to fill the vacant post in a safe manner, to the satisfaction of the Administration.
2 Any dispensation granted for a post shall be granted only to a person properly certificated to fill the post immediately below it. Where certification of the post below is not required by the Convention, a dispensation may be issued to a person whose competence and